

Kacper Kleczaj

SOFTWARE DEVELOPER, WEB AND MOBILE

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Prof. Bárbara Barroso and Prof. Rita Costa

Bragança Polytechnic University, Mirandela Campus

Łódź, 3 August 2026

Application for Heritage in Video Games, autumn 2026

Dear Professors,

I am applying for the **Heritage in Video Games** programme at the Mirandela Campus. I am a Computer Science student at Lodz University of Technology and a software developer working on web and mobile applications, and I would like to spend these weeks turning a piece of local heritage into something people can actually play.

My interest is not theoretical. At Fintech Łódź_Hack my team took first place with **Moje Osiedle**, a gamified extension of the Łódź city card that rewards residents for taking part in neighbourhood life and supporting local businesses. Building it showed me how quickly a game layer changes the way people relate to the place they live in, and how much of that place's story never gets told. I come from Łódź, a city built on the 19th century textile industry, where factory districts such as Księży Młyn survive as architecture while the memory attached to them fades. That is the kind of intangible heritage I would like to prototype around.

What I bring is the ability to ship. I have released a mobile application built in React Native to the App Store and Google Play, I build interactive interfaces in React and TypeScript, and five hackathons have taught me to get from a concept to a working prototype in days rather than months. On a team I am usually the person who makes sure the demo runs.

What I want from the programme is the other half of that equation: a structured understanding of what heritage is, including the UNESCO framing and the distinction between its tangible and intangible forms, so that my design decisions rest on method rather than intuition. I am equally drawn to working with students from Sweden, France, Finland and Spain. Heritage is precisely the subject where my Polish assumptions will not survive contact with four other cultures, and that friction is the point.

I am available for the full virtual component from 9 October to 27 November and for the physical week in Mirandela from 16 to 20 November. My English is at B2 level, which is sufficient for teamwork, documentation and presentations.

Thank you for considering my application. I would be glad to share my portfolio or discuss project ideas in more detail.

Yours sincerely,

Kacper Kleczaj